IT Incident Management Standard Operating Procedure (SOP)
Document Code: SOP-IT-2026-04 | Classification: Public | Version: 2.1

1. Purpose and Scope
This Standard Operating Procedure establishes the incident response lifecycle for all production IT services, customer porta

2. Incident Severity Classification Matrix
Incidents are categorized into three operational severity levels:

- Severity 1 (Critical): Total outage of customer-facing services, data loss vulnerability, or complete payroll system failure. Ta
- Severity 2 (Major): Degradation of core systems affecting more than 20% of users, high-latency database queries, or failur
- Severity 3 (Minor): Individual employee desktop issues, internal wiki glitches, or non-blocking report generation errors. Tar

3. Escalation Protocols
When a Severity 1 incident is confirmed, the on-duty engineer must immediately initiate the incident bridge call and notify th

4. Communication Cadence During Major Outages
During active Severity 1 incidents, status updates must be published to the public status page and internal announcement c

5. Post-Incident Review and Blameless Post-Mortem
A blameless post-mortem meeting must be conducted within 72 hours of resolving any Severity 1 or recurring Severity 2 inc

Key deliverables required for the post-mortem report include:
- A complete timestamped incident timeline detailing detection, mitigation, and resolution steps.
- Identification of root technical triggers and contributing architectural vulnerabilities.
- Action items with named owners and target completion dates not to exceed 14 business days.
- Sign-off from both the Technical Operations Director and the Product Engineering Lead.

6. Archival and Audit Compliance
All incident bridge audio recordings, chat logs, and post-mortem documents must be archived in the security vault for a mini